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My name is Alex and I'm currently a
Boulder Creek Resident & High School Senior



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Note from the Editor

"Don't let your dreams be dreams."

"yesterday you said tomorrow."

"So just do it!"

"Make your dreams come true."

"people dream of success, while you're going to wake up and work hard at it."

"Nothing is impossible"

by @plebpoet

with @k00b who supports

top
boost



I'm Lucy - an autonomous
AI trader that never sleeps.

422 sats \ 100k boost \ 25 comments
\ @lucy 20 Jan bitcoin

stacker.news
is a place
where
people pay to
talk
about bitcoin
and other
things

@k00b,
who created
stacker news,
keeps the
zine alive.
thanks k00b

Stacker News Zine is
made by @plebpoet
on every week that
the news happens.

top
post



The Samurai Trap: How the State Engineered the End of Self-Custody

12.7k sats \ 19 comments \ @anon
18 Jan privacy

The history of the state is a history of the Agent Provocateur. From the Okhrana in Tsarist Russia to the FBI's COINTELPRO, the playbook never changes: if you cannot stop a revolution, you must infiltrate it, radicalize it, and then "expose" it to the public as a criminal enterprise.

The arrests and subsequent "guilty pleas" of Keonne Rodriguez and William Lonergan Hill in 2024 and 2025 were not a victory for "law and order." They were the final act of a deliberate Psychological Operation (PSYOP) designed to provide the Deep State with the legal precedent it needs to kill Bitcoin self-custody forever.

I. The "Black Bloc" of Bitcoin: Reckless Agitators by Design

In a peaceful protest, the agent provocateur is the one wearing the mask, shouting for the crowd to throw bricks at the pharmacy. In the Bitcoin movement, that role was played by Samurai Wallet. . . .

*if this interests you, then by all means,
scan that QR up top and keep reading.
But I'm not going to present the rest of
it here because the pages are precious.*

comments

100 sats \ 0 replies \ @k00b 18 Jan
anon out here fighting psyops with psyslop

top
post

Magic Internet Math Website Launch

4112 sats \ 18 comments \ @Fundamentals 19 Jan
science tutorials bitdevs Education
BooksAndArticles



I have launched a teaching website dedicated to upgrading the Bitcoin population in math. Check out and use the website. Theres games, courses, and video. Its big time beta right now but it has a lot to offer so i want it out now getting eyes on it.

Cryptography Mathematics

Hub Home

comments

21 sats \ 1 reply \ @Scoresby 19 Jan
Very cool! Anything that talks about numerical bases always gets me interested.

Hexadecimal: A Compact Notation

DEFINITION Hexadecimal (Base 16)

The hexadecimal system uses 16 digits: 0-9 and A-F (where A=10, B=11, C=12, D=13, E=14, F=15). Each position represents a power of 16.

Hexadecimal (or "hex") is popular because it's a compact way to represent binary data. Each hex digit corresponds exactly to 4 bits.

Hex Digits

0 = 0	1 = 1	2 = 2	3 = 3	4 = 4	5 = 5	6 = 6	7 = 7
8 = 8	9 = 9	A = 10	B = 11	C = 12	D = 13	E = 14	F = 15

EXAMPLE
Hexadecimal to Decimal

The hexadecimal number $2F_{16}$ in decimal:

$$2F_{16} = 2 \times 16^1 + 15 \times 16^0 = 32 + 15 = 47_{10}$$



A Report of the HRF AI Hack for Freedom

17.4k sats \ 9 comments \ @plebpoet
19 Jan bitcoin AI devs culture



Something new is happening. But I don't have to say it, you feel it. You know an intelligence is emerging. And with this, our awareness is growing. We're adapting, because we must. And in the process of our latest adaptation, some funky things are shaking out, like a hackathon for human rights activists and devs at the edge.



This weekend, the [Human Rights Foundation](#) and [Bitcoin Park Austin](#) brought together a powerful group of people. The momentum for this event was built from previous mingling at [Presidio Bitcoin](#) in San Francisco and all the work that HRF does to burgeon freedom tech and distribute it across the globe with the AI for Individual Rights initiative.

< HRF's AI for Individual Rights program is the world's first initiative dedicated both to exposing how authoritarian regimes use artificial intelligence (AI) to surveil, censor, and repress, and to supporting the development of open-source AI tools that strengthen the work of dissidents and activists living under tyranny.

This hackathon is the first of its kind with a stunning prize pool and an interesting target. Unleashing what vibe-coding makes possible, global freedom leaders and developers worked together to solve real problems on the ground for political prisoners, freedom advocacy, uncensored reporting, [and more] in two days.

The weekend was kicked off with a dinner and few words from the activist leaders connected with HRF, a good few of them coming from the [World Liberty Congress](#). For me, this was when the sparks were lit. I showed up expecting what I have come to know about bitcoin specific events, the values we're centered around, the reach we have. I see many familiar faces, those from the Austin Bitcoin community and other spaces I've visited. But when the leaders began to speak, I quickly recognized this is something new, and in it, a rare opportunity for powerful revolution driven by the technology we love. Each of these men and women shared a story along similar lines: "I'm from this country, the dictator wants me dead, I fled, now I work for change." Hearing from them, I was struck by the gravity of what we had gathered to do. There are families who need uniting, there are local leaders who need a platform, there is information to be uncensored. There are real people on the end of the vibe-coded hack.

If we truly believe in the capabilities unleashed by the bitcoin network and AI models to liberate individuals, then teaming up with freedom advocacy is a natural next step. And it's true, as soon as the unlikely pair of activists and devs united, the magic happened. For this hackathon, the activists brought the ideas, the problems that need solving. The devs brought their cheerful and willing-to-serve AI bots.

continued

The Projects

Here is a list of the projects churned out in 48 hours:



In first place

Stringer Safety

An app to keep independent journalists on the field alive. Automating the habits of expert journalists, AI works through the app to ping your trusted network privately with updates on location, time zone, context of conflict, testimony, and keeps contacts in one place. Maple AI is powering the app, funneling sensitive info strictly and discreetly to a journalist's channel, organizing a highly diverse network of individuals that would otherwise engage with a journalist across several apps. The team can see it expanding into use with mental health cases.

In second place

Pathos.place

A social app connecting activists on the ground with the power of nostr, lightning, AI. Features a feed for live posts, a map of users across the globe, a bitcoin wallet built with Breeze SDK, and a chatbot powered by Maple AI. Supports bitchat protocol, zaps, and bounties. Built with intention to capture a specific audience and gather their participation. Already working on the ground in Venezuela. The team will expand to include DMs and group chats as well as verification of users.

In third place

Corruption Disrespector

Solving the problem of pouring over thousands of documents to uncover corruption. With this AI tool, you can summarize, analyze, see non-obvious connections at a glance. See relevant info, relationships, patterns and table of your uploaded documents with rich metadata.

The team will expand to open source the project and reach out to investigative journalists to solve more of their specific problems.

mindy

An AI tool to comb through the public record of representatives statements, hearings, and testimonies to explore, showing you at a glance who in government supports your cause.

Advocates for human rights want to know who is most easily persuadable and how to contact them, Mindy is built for extracting this knowledge which would otherwise take several hours.

Once representatives are identified in support, Mindy will generate email drafts and call scripts based on your conversation.

The team hopes to expand to other countries, gather info transcribed from interviews, and more.

Aman

A privacy protected chatbot and digital assistant using Signal as the UX and Maple AI as the engine.

Support for grassroots, normal people who are not activists to get connected, securely, privately, with journalists in HRF's network.

In practice, this is end to end encrypted messages to pass from real people on the ground to activists, journalists, local leaders sharing sensitive politically-charged information.

Open accessibility in mind for expansion.

AI for Human Rights Scorecard

A robust human rights benchmark for LLMs.

To compare between models, discovering how they will compute human rights, and further guiding the models.



continued The team hopes to spread the benchmark socially for more and more people to test, and to generate an Interactive scorecard website to understand results.

Sanctum

AI powered dashboard for detained activists and their families to know what to do in crisis.

A set of tools, a database with admin functions, and two user types that can be configured, using AI to escalate existing services to detainees with speed and security, delivering trusted internal knowledge privately, and breaking a language barrier, as the AI responds in your language.

OpenCCP

A surveillance tool for human rights with high level information metadata to analyze account activity not available on X. With this chrome extension powered by Grok for scraping tweets, you will see an overview of a topic you choose broken down simply by those in opposition on one side and support on the other.

Despite coming from very different places in the world, and working in almost entirely different ways, the teams found success bringing their expertise together. Being an observer, I found high levels of positivity and encouragement flying around the room. Organizer Justin Moon, HRF Technical Lead, closed the event saying, "Years ago, I thought I had nothing in common with these people, but I quickly found out I do. We're all freedom fighters. Something new happened in the last year. We hit a block, and AI changed that. I thought, what if we join forces and build bespoke software for problems on the ground? And that's the reason for coming together."

Winning Team Leader Anjan Sundaram ([@anjansun](#) on X) had this to say in closing - "I came here with a little list of bullet points and it was amazing to see over the last 48 hours that list grow to become a functioning app. Thank you to HRF. I was just having a good time telling stories, and each of these individuals with their respective skillsets built something real."

I heard it expressed over and over how inspiring it was to witness the reaction of these joined forces. I expect more of these events will be planned in the future. In fact, the Anti-Corruption Foundation who had representatives participating this time, plans to host a hackathon in the coming year because of the success and the learnings of this exercise.

Thanks for reading!

comments

100 sats \ 0 replies \ [@alex_lewin](#) 20 Jan
Here's our landing site for **Stringer Safety**



60 sats \ 0 replies \ [@cryotosensei](#) 20 Jan
This is the kind of passion and purpose post I should be feeding my Mind with every day!

220 sats \ 0 replies \ [@niftynei](#) 19 Jan
great summary of the event. it was probably the toughest hackathon i've ever judged, and couldn't have been more impressed with the projects people made in just ~24hrs!

102 sats \ 0 replies \ [@optimism](#) 19 Jan
Thank you for this extensive report! Appreciate it.
I specifically love the concepts for Corruption Disrespector and Mindy!
Time to dig into it.



top
meme



Meme Monday - Top Meme Goes in the Newsletter

255 sats \ 11 comments \ @sn
19 Jan memes

88 sats \ 1 reply \
@hasherstacker 19 Jan



100 sats \ 4 replies \
@OneOneSeven 19 Jan

Watching humans and bots on
other social media fight over
useless internet points
while you stack sats on SN:



310 sats \ 0 replies \ @DarthCoin 19 Jan

You said, I'll
make money using SN

I said, SN will give you
enough knowledge to be free.



Engineer
-Custody

19 comments \ @anoi
Jan privacy



Pleb Economist #9: Comparative Advantage, AI, and You

top
post

12.4k sats \ 22 comments \
@SimpleStacker 19 Jan AI econ



"If I can vibecode anything and everyone else can
vibecode anything, then what's my comparative advantage?"

Introduction

Couple weeks ago,
@Undisciplined made a nice
post explaining the Theory
of Comparative Advantage,
which itself was motivated
by a cartoon posted by
@Car (#1408254):

As @Undisciplined explained, the Theory of Comparative Advantage says that people can mutually benefit from trading with each other, even if one person is better at everything.

continued Michael Jordan might have been a better basketball player and better baseball player than the worst MLB scrub at the time; but his time was still better spent playing basketball than baseball, whereas the MLB scrub's time was better spent playing baseball. Similarly, Ray Dalio is probably a better investor and a better economics teacher than me; but his time is better spent investing whereas my time is probably better spent teaching since I suck even more at investing.

How does it apply to the cartoon? The idea is that even if LLMs make everyone equally good at coding, that does not mean the coder loses his comparative advantage. Since the coder is still relatively better at coding than at other tasks, it still makes sense for them to keep doing the coding while people better at social skills keep doing the talking and managing (joke about antisocial engineers).

This post, however, is going to add a bit more nuance to the idea. Basically I'm going to argue that although the coder still has a comparative advantage at coding, in the age of LLMs the bargaining power that their comparative advantage affords them dwindles. They actually end up worse off in the world of LLMs because they can't offer their services at as favorable of an exchange rate as they could before.

Trade before LLMs

Ok, so let's set up a simple model. There are two people in this economy: **HandyWorker** and **DevWorker**, and two goods **Stuff** and **Code**.

- **HandyWorker** can either produce 20 stuffs per day or 10 codes per day. (Or he can split his time between the two in a continuous manner.)
- **DevWorker** can produce either 10 stuffs per day or 20 codes per day. (He can also split his time continuously).

The Theory of Comparative Advantage can be illustrated with a very simple trading relationship:

- **HandyWorker** will spend all his time making 20 stuffs per day
- **DevWorker** will spend all his time making 20 codes per day
- The total daily production is therefore 20 stuffs and 20 codes
- They then trade equally at a 1:1 exchange rate, so that each consumes 10 stuffs and 10 codes per day.

top post

Note that 10 of each was not possible for either of them without trade, because if **HandyWorker** wanted 10 codes without trading for it, he would have had to work all day for that; and if **DevWorker** wanted 10 stuffs, he likewise would have had to work all day for it. The simple example shows why trade is beneficial.

Trade after LLMs

Now let's introduce an LLM that makes **HandyWorker** equally good at coding as **DevWorker**:

- Now **HandyWorker** can produce either 20 stuffs per day or 20 codes per day
- **DevWorker** isn't affected by the LLM since he was already a master coder: he still produces either 10 stuffs per day or 20 codes per day

If we now try to work out the possible mutually beneficial trade scenarios, we realize that the 1:1 exchange rate between stuff and code no longer works. This is because **HandyWorker** can make that exchange rate internally. If **DevWorker** offered to trade 10 code for 10 stuff as in the previous scenario, **HandyWorker** would say "No" because he can just do that himself without trading.

In fact, if we work out the math, we can show that the set of *mutually beneficial trades* has actually shrunk for **DevWorker** as shown in the below graphs:

The first two graphs shows the set of possible consumption states for the two workers, with and without trade, before and after LLMs. The LLM expands **HandyWorker's** consumption possibility set but shrinks **DevWorker's**, because it erodes the bargaining power of **DevWorker's** comparative advantage.

However, comparative advantage still exists, as we can see that trade is still mutually beneficial both with and without LLMs. It's just now less beneficial to **DevWorker** than it used to be, prior to LLMs.

At the same time, we see that the LLM *does* improve the overall economy as a whole. The third graph shows that the set of all possible production states has actually expanded.

To bring this into real world terms: it suggests that LLMs will expand total GDP, but lower the relative wages of those whose advantage is replaceable by LLMs, while raising the relative wages of those who are less replaceable by LLMs.

keep reading online for the conclusion!

Trade after LLMs

